

6.22 IRREGULAR TURNAROUND OPERATIONS

Irregular events may include:

- Equipment failures.
- Weather disruptions.
- Fueling delays.
- Maintenance delays.
- Passenger disruptions.
- Security incidents.

Personnel shall follow approved contingency procedures and coordinate corrective actions to minimize operational impact.

6.23 CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

Ground operations and turnaround procedures shall be reviewed periodically through audits, inspections, safety reviews, operational analysis, and performance monitoring.

Lessons learned from incidents, delays, disruptions, and operational reviews shall be incorporated into future procedures to improve safety, efficiency, reliability, and service quality.

END OF SECTION 6 – GROUND OPERATIONS & AIRCRAFT TURNAROUND OPERATIONS

SECTION 7

DISPATCH & FLIGHT PLANNING

Document ID: OPS-DSP-001

Department: Flight Dispatch

Category: Dispatch & Flight Planning

Priority: Critical

Version: 1.0

Reference Sources

- FAA Flight Dispatch Guidance
 - FAA Airport Operations Handbook
 - Flight Operations Manual Template
 - UK OTAC Operations Manual Guidance
-

7.1 PURPOSE

The purpose of Dispatch and Flight Planning Operations is to ensure that every flight is planned, authorized, monitored, and supported in accordance with regulatory requirements, operational limitations, safety standards, and company policies. Flight dispatch personnel are responsible for evaluating operational conditions, assessing risks, coordinating resources, and providing flight crews with the information required for safe and efficient operations.

7.2 SCOPE

Dispatch responsibilities include flight planning, route analysis, fuel planning, weather assessment, airport suitability review, NOTAM analysis, operational risk assessment, flight release preparation, operational monitoring, and coordination with operational stakeholders.

Dispatch personnel serve as the primary operational planning authority before departure.

7.3 FLIGHT SCHEDULING REVIEW

Prior to flight planning, dispatch personnel shall review:

- Flight schedules.
- Aircraft assignments.
- Crew assignments.
- Airport operating hours.
- Slot restrictions.
- Operational notices.

Any operational conflict shall be identified and resolved before flight release.

7.4 ROUTE PLANNING

Dispatch personnel shall select routes based on:

- Operational efficiency.
- Air traffic restrictions.
- Weather conditions.
- Fuel efficiency.
- Airspace availability.
- Regulatory requirements.

Flight routes shall comply with approved navigation procedures and operational limitations.

7.5 WEATHER ANALYSIS

Weather assessments shall include:

- Departure airport conditions.
- Destination airport conditions.
- Alternate airport conditions.
- Enroute weather.
- Convective activity.
- Turbulence forecasts.
- Wind conditions.
- Visibility restrictions.

Weather information shall be continuously monitored throughout the planning process.

7.6 NOTAM REVIEW

Dispatch personnel shall review all applicable Notices to Air Missions (NOTAMs).

Review areas include:

- Runway closures.
- Taxiway closures.
- Navigation aid outages.
- Airport construction.
- Airspace restrictions.
- Temporary procedures.

Operational impacts shall be assessed before flight release.

7.7 AIRCRAFT PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

Aircraft performance calculations shall consider:

- Aircraft type.
- Aircraft weight.
- Runway conditions.
- Temperature.
- Elevation.
- Wind conditions.
- Operational restrictions.

Dispatch personnel shall ensure the aircraft can safely operate within all performance limitations.

7.8 FUEL PLANNING

Fuel planning shall ensure sufficient fuel is carried for:

- Taxi operations.
- Trip fuel.
- Contingency fuel.
- Alternate fuel.
- Holding fuel.
- Regulatory reserves.

Additional fuel may be authorized when operational conditions indicate increased risk.

7.9 ALTERNATE AIRPORT SELECTION

Suitable alternate airports shall be selected when required.

Selection criteria include:

- Weather suitability.
- Runway capability.
- Operational status.
- Aircraft compatibility.
- Fuel requirements.

Alternate airports shall remain available throughout the planned operation.

7.10 FLIGHT RELEASE PREPARATION

Dispatch personnel shall prepare a flight release containing:

- Flight routing.
- Fuel requirements.
- Weather information.
- NOTAM information.
- Operational restrictions.
- Aircraft information.

The flight release serves as official authorization for flight operations.

7.11 FLIGHT CREW BRIEFING

Flight crews shall receive all operationally significant information before departure.

Briefing topics may include:

- Weather concerns.
- Fuel considerations.
- Airport restrictions.
- Aircraft limitations.
- Operational risks.

Questions and concerns shall be addressed before departure authorization.

7.12 OPERATIONAL RISK ASSESSMENT

Dispatch personnel shall evaluate operational risks associated with:

- Weather.
- Maintenance limitations.
- Airport conditions.
- Crew limitations.
- Security concerns.
- Airspace restrictions.

Risk mitigation measures shall be implemented when necessary.

7.13 PRE-DEPARTURE MONITORING

Prior to departure, dispatch personnel shall monitor:

- Aircraft readiness.
- Crew readiness.
- Weather developments.
- Airport conditions.
- Fuel status.
- Maintenance status.

Any significant change shall trigger reassessment of operational suitability.

7.14 ENROUTE FLIGHT MONITORING

After departure, dispatch personnel shall continue monitoring:

- Flight progress.
- Weather conditions.
- Airspace restrictions.
- Fuel consumption.
- Operational deviations.

Operational support shall be provided throughout the flight.

7.15 FLIGHT DIVERSION SUPPORT

If a diversion becomes necessary, dispatch personnel shall:

- Identify suitable diversion airports.
- Evaluate operational conditions.
- Coordinate ground support.
- Provide information to flight crews.

Diversion decisions shall prioritize safety.

7.16 IRREGULAR OPERATIONS

Dispatch personnel shall coordinate responses to:

- Delays.
- Diversions.
- Cancellations.
- Aircraft substitutions.
- Airport closures.
- Weather disruptions.

Operational recovery plans shall be developed to minimize disruption.

7.17 POST-FLIGHT REVIEW

Following flight completion, dispatch personnel shall review:

- Operational performance.
- Fuel performance.
- Weather impacts.
- Delays.
- Operational deviations.

Lessons learned shall be incorporated into future planning activities.

7.18 PERFORMANCE MONITORING

Dispatch performance shall be monitored through:

- On-time performance.
- Fuel efficiency.